Amer Sports Inc. (AS): Salomon Investor Day Takeaways

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We attended the Amer Sports Investor Day in Annecy, France on September 17th. At the event, AS updated its long-term financial targets and outlined a path for Salomon to grow at a mid-teens CAGR (to >$5bn). Management expects broad-based growth at the Salomon brand across geographies, channels, and product categories, but management sees particular opportunity in running, sportstyle, head to toe apparel, and DTC growth as key accelerators. This is supported by an expansion of the company's key epicenter strategy to new cities globally. Regarding near-term trends, management also raised its F3Q guidance for sales and operating profit margins and also clarified that the base from which EBIT margins will grow (FY26) is the ex-tariff base of 13.8-14.1%.

Key messages from the event included: (1) Salomon has moved beyond its legacy outdoor and winter sports equipment roots into a broader softgoods growth platform, with footwear now representing the majority of the business and sportstyle becoming a large growth engine. (2) Management positioned the brand's long-term opportunity around category expansion from a $25bn core outdoor/WSE market into a $135bn performance and sport footwear opportunity, and over time a $300bn head-to-toe addressable market. (3) The company's 2031 Salomon framework calls for mid-teens sales CAGR and 20-60bps+ of annual operating margin expansion, with growth expected to be broad-based across regions and supported by both category mix and channel mix. (4) Sportstyle remains the most visible unlock, and management emphasized franchise diversification beyond XT-6, disciplined marketplace management, and continued use of collaborations, capsules, and product newness to sustain heat. (5) Running is expected to become a more meaningful performance growth vector, with gravel positioned as Salomon's next major bet and road expansion supported by technology transfer, athlete credibility, and the recently announced Ironman partnership. (6) At the Amer Sports portfolio level, management reiterated that the company has three growth engines in Arc'teryx, Salomon softgoods, and Wilson Tennis 360. The company continues to preserve flexibility to invest behind brand equity, DTC, marketing, IT, and talent. (7) Management indicated that M&A is not a priority and that share repurchase will only be utilized to offset dilution.

Our view: We step away from the event with increased confidence that Salomon has multiple increasingly balanced paths to sustain above-market growth. We were impressed by the playbook in performance running and the clearer articulation of brand differentiation and cadence of innovation. The company has a deep bench of

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strong talent. Additionally, we were pleased to see management indicate an expansion of its successful key city epicenter strategy to additional cities. We believe the clear plans regarding management's regional and product plans provide greater visibility to the structural long-term growth of the company. Importantly, we believe the long-term algorithm for Amer Sports and the Salomon business remain achievable and prudent. That said, we recognize a tough athletic backdrop that has weighed on multiple performance in the sector and believe continued execution will be required to drive stock outperformance from here. We reiterate our Buy rating.

Key takeaways:

- **3Q guidance raised:** The company raised its 3Q26 guidance, now expecting Y/Y revenue growth of 20-22% (from 18-20% prior), which compares to prior GS/FactSet consensus at 20.1%/20.0%, respectively. AS now expects adj. operating margin to be slightly above the high end of its previously guided range of 13.5-14%, which compares to GS/consensus at 13.1%/13.2%, respectively.
- **Long-term algorithm reiterated from a higher base:** AS updated its 5+ year framework to now be based off of FY26 as the base year, and is still calling for a low-double-digit to mid-teens annual revenue CAGR and 30-70bps+ of annual adjusted operating margin expansion. This implies $3+ of EPS by 2031. Importantly, management maintained the framework despite a meaningfully higher revenue and margin base versus a year ago, with Arc'teryx, Salomon Softgoods, and Wilson Tennis 360 still identified as the key growth engines. Segment-level targets also support the breadth of the algorithm, with Technical Apparel and Outdoor Performance expected to grow mid-teens annually, Ball & Racquet expected to grow mid- to high-single digits, and all three segments targeting 20-60bps+ of annual adjusted operating margin expansion. We note that the company now expects a slightly more prudent margin expansion plan for the B&R and OP segments vs. prior (now 20-60bps+ vs. 40-80bps prior), which management attributed to recent outperformance and reinvestment in growth.
- **Salomon is diversified and has several channels for growth:** Management framed Salomon as a diversified growth platform rather than a brand dependent on one franchise or one geography, with 40% of 2026E sales from sportstyle footwear, 30% from performance footwear, 15% from winter sports equipment, and 15% from head-to-toe apparel and bags. Footwear remains the core investment priority at roughly 70% of the business, but the broader message was that sportstyle, running, apparel, bags, DTC, and regional expansion can each contribute to the next leg of growth.
- **Sportstyle remains the largest unlock, with new consumer acquisition supporting the opportunity:** Sportstyle has grown roughly 30x from 2021 to 2026E and now represents the largest softgoods category, while management noted that 80% of sportstyle consumers are new to Salomon. Management described sportstyle as a meaningfully larger market opportunity than performance footwear and highlighted continued product newness, collaborations, capsules, and franchise development as core elements of the growth playbook.
- **Sportstyle diversification remains a key focus as Salomon moves beyond XT-6:**

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Management addressed the concern that Salomon's sportstyle opportunity could be overly dependent on XT-6, noting that the sneaker market is materially larger than performance footwear and that the brand is still early in building out a broader portfolio. The team emphasized XT-6 lifecycle management, newer franchises such as XT-Whisper and ACS, additional launches in the pipeline, and tight control over marketplace supply through curated wholesale allocations; management also cited product scarcity, merchandising breadth, and marketing allocation as tools to manage product lifecycle and sustain franchise momentum.

- **Performance is also a growth driver, with gravel running the next frontier:** Management continued to anchor Salomon's credibility in trail, where the brand has established leadership, but the more incremental message was the expansion into gravel and road. Gravel was described as the next big bet, already 15% of 2026E running sales after 3x growth versus 2025, while road expansion is supported by the Aero Glide and Ultra Glide platforms, athlete validation, and the Ironman partnership beginning in 2027.
- **China remains a key proof point for brand-direct execution at scale with further growth ahead:** Greater China has grown from less than $30mn to a high triple-digit million-dollar business, with management citing roughly 330 stores in 2026E, an 85% retail mix, and strong store productivity. The 2031 target calls for high-teens growth, driven by continued retail productivity, high-teens digital and social commerce growth, localized product, and apparel as a more important building block.
- **North America remains early, with a clear acceleration roadmap:** North America is Salomon's smallest region but the largest global footwear market, and management acknowledged the business is still early in the reset. The plan centers on curated wholesale partnerships, door expansion in run and sportstyle, improved door productivity, 30-40 owned stores across seven cities over time, and an epicenter strategy in New York and Los Angeles expanding to additional cities: Boston, Washington, Chicago, Miami, and San Francisco. The 2031 target calls for low-twenties CAGR, with high-teens wholesale growth and faster owned retail growth.
- **EMEA remains the home-market anchor, with growth shifting toward premium distribution and DTC:** Management described Europe as Salomon's largest region at 40% of 2026E sales and a market where the brand has grown roughly 2x faster than the market. The next phase is expected to be low-double-digit growth, supported by sportstyle and running, premium wholesale doors, a more balanced owned-store fleet, full-price DTC, and replication of the Paris playbook into London and other key cities.
- **Marketing investment is shifting from demand capture to brand building:** Management highlighted a more deliberate marketing model, with spend doubled over the last two years and a shift away from short-term paid search toward awareness, consideration, campaigns, partnerships, and community. Early proof points included improved brand awareness in key epicenters, a younger and more gender-balanced DTC customer base, and measurable campaign lift from Gravel and

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XT-Whisper activations.

- **Winter sports equipment is smaller in mix but important to authenticity:** Winter sports equipment represents 15% of Salomon sales and is expected to grow low- to mid-single digits versus an 8% CAGR from 2021 to 2026, but management positioned the segment as a core source of brand credibility, identity, and amplification. Salomon remains the #1 winter sports equipment brand with 13% market share, while Amer Sports' combined Salomon, Atomic, and Armada footprint represents roughly 30% of the market.
- **Salomon margin expansion is expected to come through mix and scale while funding reinvestment:** Management expects Salomon to deliver 20-60bps+ of annual operating margin expansion, with gross margin supported by footwear, sportstyle, DTC, regional mix, and premiumization. SG&A leverage is expected to be modest, particularly earlier in the plan, as the company continues to invest in marketing, DTC expansion, epicenters, digital/IT/AI, and talent.

Estimates, valuation and key risks

We update our FY26/FY27/FY28 EPS estimates to $1.32/$1.68/$2.03 from $1.31/$1.67/$1.98 prior to reflect stronger 3Q trends and faster growth momentum across the Salomon portfolio, partially offset by a slightly lower rate of margin expansion in FY27 vs. our prior expectations. Our 12-month price target moves to $43 from $48 on our updated estimates to reflect a lower target multiple. Our target multiple moves to 14.0x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA from 16.0x prior to reflect recent market multiple rerating.

Key downside risks include: (1) Slower than anticipated growth in the Greater China market; (2) Weaker brand momentum due to slower innovation; (3) Corporate structure, including the company's Cayman Islands incorporation and shifts in support from several majority shareholders; and (4) Lower real estate availability or quality.

AS	12m Price Target: **$43.00**	Price: **$26.27**	Upside: **63.7%**

Buy

Market cap: $15.5bn
Enterprise value: $14.7bn
3m ADTV: $185.9mn
United States
Americas Apparel & Accessories Brands
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**6,566.2**	**8,203.8**	**9,455.5**	**10,747.7**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	6,566.2	8,168.0	9,238.7	10,308.0
EBITDA ($ mn)	1,150.7	1,603.1	1,864.2	2,196.9
EBIT ($ mn)	837.7	1,190.9	1,394.9	1,649.0
EPS ($) New	**0.97**	**1.32**	**1.68**	**2.03**
EPS ($) Old	0.97	1.31	1.67	1.98
P/E (X)	34.2	19.9	15.6	12.9
Dividend yield (%)	–	–	–	–
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.2	(0.5)	(0.9)	(1.2)

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS ($)	0.22	0.34	0.39	0.50

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 17 Sep 2026 close.

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Disclosure Appendix

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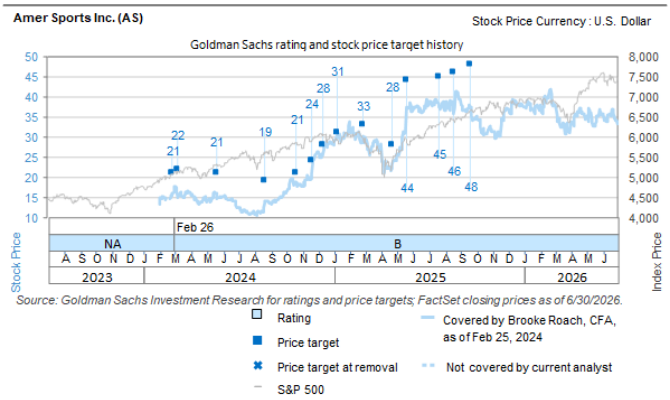
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Amer Sports Inc. (AS)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
19-Sep-25	48.00	37.45
19-Aug-25	46.00	35.74
21-Jul-25	45.00	38.18
21-May-25	44.00	37.00
22-Apr-25	28.00	22.25
25-Feb-25	33.00	28.83
08-Jan-25	31.00	30.53
10-Dec-24	28.00	25.64
20-Nov-24	24.00	20.96
21-Oct-24	21.00	18.86
20-Aug-24	19.00	13.63
22-May-24	21.00	15.01
06-Mar-24	22.00	15.16
26-Feb-24	21.00	16.10

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